

3.1.2 Area of study 1: Western classical tradition 1650–1910 (compulsory)

For the purposes of this specification, the western classical tradition is defined as art music of (or growing out of) the European tradition, normally notated, and normally intended for public performance.

Listening – unfamiliar music

Students must be able to listen attentively to unfamiliar music from the following styles/genres to identify and accurately describe musical elements, musical contexts and musical language:

- The Coronation Anthems and Oratorios of Handel.
- The Orchestra Music of Haydn, Mozart and Beethoven.
- The piano music of Chopin and Schumann.
- The Requiem of the late Romantic period.

Study piece

Mozart: *Clarinet Concerto in A major*, K. 622, 3rd movement, Rondo (first taught 2020, first assessed 2022, final assessment 2025).

Beethoven: *Symphony No. 1*, Movement 1: Adagio molto – Allegro con brio (first taught 2024, first assessed 2026)

Musical elements

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section B (Study piece). Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms if relevant to this area of study in section B (Study piece) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• conjunct, disjunct, triadic, broken chords, scalar, arpeggio • intervals within the octave • passing notes • diatonic, chromatic • slide/portamento, ornamentation including acciaccaturas, appoggiaturas • ostinato • phrasing, articulation.
Harmony	• diatonic, chromatic • consonant, dissonant • pedal, drone • cadences: perfect, plagal, imperfect, interrupted and tierce de Picardie • identification of major, minor and dominant seventh chords using chord symbols/roman numerals.

Element type	Element
Tonality	• major, minor, and their key signatures to four sharps and flats • modulation to dominant, subdominant in major or minor keys • relative major or minor • tonic major or minor.
Structure	• binary and ternary • rondo • arch-shape • through-composed • theme and variations, sonata, minuet and trio, scherzo and trio • call and response • ground bass, continuo • cadenza.
Sonority (Timbre)	• instruments and voices singly and in combination as found in music, including that for solo instruments, concertos, chamber groups • instrumental techniques such as arco, pizzicato, con sordino.
Texture	• harmonic/homophonic/chordal • polyphonic/contrapuntal • imitative, canonic, layered • antiphonal • a cappella • monophonic/single melody line • melody and accompaniment • unison, octaves.
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• simple and compound time • regular • anacrusis • common Italian tempo terms eg allegro, andante • pulse • augmentation, diminution • hemiola • semibreve, minim, crotchet, quaver, semiquaver • dotted rhythms, triplets, scotch snap • rubato, pause • tempo.
Dynamics and articulation	Gradation of dynamics as follows: • <i>pp, p, mp, mf, f, ff</i> including the Italian terms • <i>cresc, crescendo, dim, diminuendo</i> including hairpins • <i>sfz, sforzando</i> • common signs, terms and symbols.